



On-Track Safety and Worker Protection

FRA reference: 49 CFR Part 214, Subpart C



NO ONE FOULS A TRACK UNTIL ON-TRACK SAFETY IS SET

Plain language explanation

Roadway worker protection keeps people safe when they work on or near the track. Before anyone fouls a track, a form of on-track safety must be set, such as working limits or a watchman who warns of trains. Every worker has to know which protection is in place and how they will be warned.

Why it matters

Trains are heavy, quiet, and cannot stop quickly. A worker focused on a task may never hear one coming. On-track safety gives them a warning or a protected work zone so a train and a worker never share the same piece of track.

Real-world scenario

A track crew needs to change a rail on an active line. The worker in charge sets working limits so no train can enter without permission, and names a watchman to warn the crew. When a train needs through, the crew clears and the watchman calls out. Everyone is accounted for before it moves, and the job finishes with no close calls.

Supervisor takeaways

- 1 Set a form of on-track safety before anyone fouls the track.
- 2 Make sure every worker knows the protection and how they get warned.
- 3 If the protection is unclear, stop and get it fixed before working.

This is one issue of 52. Your crew gets a new one every Monday.